Submission Worksheet

Submission Data

Course: IT265-002-S2026
Assignment: IT265 Design Treatment Checkpoint
Student: Kelsey C. (kc776)
Status: Submitted | **Worksheet Progress:** 100%
Potential Grade: 10.00/10.00 (100.00%)
Received Grade: 0.00/10.00 (0.00%)
Started: 3/3/2026 11:55:49 AM
Updated: 3/9/2026 7:40:29 PM
Grading Link: https://learn.ethereallab.app/assignment/v3/IT265-002-S2026/it265-design-treatment-checkpoint/grading/kc776
View Link: https://learn.ethereallab.app/assignment/v3/IT265-002-S2026/it265-design-treatment-checkpoint/view/kc776

Instructions

Objective: Individually create a detailed design treatment for an original board game, covering the concept, gameplay mechanics, visual style, target audience, and inclusivity features. This foundational work will lead to further development phases.

1. Work on the below tasks (recommended to do in the order provided). 2, After you have the core concepts/sketches seek external feedback from 3 different people, preferably people from your target audience
2. Once all items are filled out, ensure this worksheet is saved and explore the PDF
3. Upload the PDF to a branch called `DesignTreatment` on GitHub
4. Create a pull request to main, and complete the merge
5. Upload the same PDF to Canvas

Section #1: (2 pts.) Crafting The Game Treatment

Progress: 100%

Task #1 (0.29 pts.) - Possible Title(s) of the Game

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Propose fitting title(s) reflecting the game's essence
- Explanation of title(s) choices

Your Response:

Title: Into the Shadows The title reflects the core gameplay where players explore a

mysterious haunted mainsion filled with hidden rooms, secrets, and supernatual dangers. It emphasizes the feeling of stepping deeper into darkerness and uncertainty as the story unfolds.

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Task #2 (0.29 pts.) - Game Setting

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Thoroughly describe the setting

Your Response:

The game takes place in a large abandoned mansion on the outskirts of a forgotten town. The mansion was once owned by a powerful family that mysteriously disappeared. Since then, rumors have spread about the strange phenomena that occurs in this mansion, such as flickering lights, figures moving through the windows, the disappearance of brave trespassers. Inside, the mansion is constantly changing. Rooms appear where walls once stood, corridors twist unexpectedly, and hidden passageways open without warning. Dust-covered libraries, candlelit hallways, underground crypts, and forgotten laboratories fill the mansion.

Key environmental elements include dark corridors, hidden rooms, environental storytelling (old journals, mysterious symbols, scattered belongings hinting at the tragic history of the mansion), dynamic exploration (layout of the board can change per gameplay).

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Task #3 (0.29 pts.) - Game Characters

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Thoroughly describe the characters

Your Response:

Players take the role of explorers investigating the haunted mansion. Each character has unique abilities and motivations that influence gameplay.

The investigator: A researcher determined to uncover the truth behind the mansions dark history. Strengths are strong puzzle solving abilities and can analyze clues more effectively. Weakness is limited combat ability.

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The occultist: A specialist in supernatural knowledge who understands rituals and spirits. Strengths are weakening supernatural enemies and can interact with cursed objects safely. Weakness is vulnerable to physical traps.

The scout: A fast and agile character skilled at exploring dangerous areas. Strengths are agility and avoiding traps more easily. Weakness is a lower ability to interpret clues.

The survivor: Someone who previously escaped the mansion and returned to face their fears. Strengths are high defense against enemies and resistant to fear effects. Weakness is puzzle solving abilities are low.

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Task #4 (0.29 pts.) - Game Theme

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Thoroughly describe the theme

Your Response:

The primary theme of the game is mystery and survival within a haunted house. Core thematic elements include fear of the known, players never know what room or event will appear next; exploration, the mansion slowly reveals itself through tile placement; psychological tension, players must decide whether to keep exploring or retreat to safety; supernatural horror, ghosts, cursed artifacts, and strange phenomena influence gameplay. The game balances suspense, discovery and cooperative problem solving to create an immersive horror experience.

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Task #5 (0.29 pts.) - Game Story

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Thoroughly describe the story

Your Response:

Many years ago, the Cavendish family mansion was the center of weath and influence in the region. The family was known for their fascination with forbidden knowledge and strange experiments. Then one night, something went terribly wrong. Neighbors

and strange experiments. Then one night...something went terribly wrong...Neighbors reported hearing screams, violent gusts of wind and unnatural lights shining from the mansion windows. When authorities arrived, the mansion was empty. The entire Cavendish family had vanished without a trace. Since then, the mansion has remained abandoned. There are rumors of strange events occuring inside the mansion and those who have entered alone have never returned.. Players are part of a team of investigators sent to uncover the truth. As they explore deeper into the mansion, they discover clues revealing that the Cavendish family attemtped to open a gateway to another realm! Now the mansion seems alive and reacts to those who dare enter. Players must decide whether to solve the mystery and stop the darkness or risk becoming part of the mansion's curse!

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Task #6 (0.29 pts.) - Objectives and Conflicts

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Describe the goals and challenges within the game

Your Response:

Goal: PLayers must explore the mansion, uncover clues, and survive long enough to solve the mystery. Victory conditions include collecting key clues, completing a ritual to seal the supernatural presence and escaping the mansion before it consumes them.

Challenges: An unpredictable map layout forces players to adapt their strategies unless they coincidentally get the same layout for the physical board. Supernatural threats - ghosts, traps and curses may appear during exploration. Limited resources - players must carefully manage items like lanterns, keys, or protective charms. Team coordination - success requires players to share information and work together.

Overall these challenges create constant tension and strategic decision-making.

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Task #7 (0.29 pts.) - Game Mechanics

Progress: 100%

Details:

- List each mechanic with supporting details to clearly portray the mechanic

Your Response:

Tile exploration: Players reveal new room tiles when entering unexplored areas. Tiles are placed upside down on placemats. Rooms should be shuffled before game starts and then placed on respected spaces for rooms. There are tiles/spaces that lead up to all of the rooms. Some of these rooms trigger events.

Event cards: When entering certain rooms, players draw event cards. Possible outcomes may be finding items, triggering traps, encountering enemies, discovering clues. This adds unpredictability and storytelling.

Character abilities: Each character has a unique strength that affects gameplay. Such as, fast movement, better puzzle solving abilities, stronger combat, etc. This also encourages teamwork and strategic role selection.

Item collection: PLayers can collect items that help them survive. Such as, lanterns, keys, protective charms, healing supplies, etc.

Fear system: Some events cause characters to gain fear points. The effects of fear points are reduced effectiveness, temporary inability to act, increased vulnerability.

Cooperative strategy: Players share information and plan moves together through coordinating exploration, protecting weaker players and combining abilities.

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Section #2: (1 pt.) Target Audience Analysis

Progress: 100%

Task #1 (1 pt.) - Identify and analyze the game's target audience

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Clearly identify the target audience
- Include analysis of demographics, interests, and gaming habits
- Justification of appeal to target audience

Your Response:

Target audience would be 13 and up, player count is 2-4 people and skill level would be beginner to intermediate tabletop players. The target audience would be people who typically enjoy horror themes, mystery solving, exploration, cooperative and narrative driven game experiences. Typical gaming habits would include family game nights or casual game nights with friends, those who enjoy immersive storytelling, the always changing maps makes it refreshing for those who enjoy replaying games.

The game appeals to this audience because it provides replayability, social interaction, a mysterious atmosphere that reminds older generations of childhood games such as

clue, betrayal at house on the hill or even mansion of madness.

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Section #3: (1 pt.) Accessibility And Inclusivity Strategies

Progress: 100%

Task #1 (1 pt.) - Outline strategies to make your game accessible and inclusive

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Include considerations for diverse abilities
- Outline inclusivity strategies for a wide audience
- Discuss implementation of noted inclusivity strategies without compromising gameplay

Your Response:

The goal is to make into the shadows playable by a wide range of players with different abilities and experience levels while maintainging suspense and strategic gameplay. Visual accessibility - To support those with visual impairments or color vision deficiencies I could add high contrast colors between floors, walls and tokens. Add clear pixel icons representing traps, items and events. Symbol paired with colors so players do not rely solely on color. An example of this would be adding a yellow swirl icon on event tiles, a red crack on a trap card and a green chest icon for item tiles. Icons appear directly on tiles and cards so players instantly recognize them. Cognitive accessibility - To support this, I would make the rules simpler or add a clearer structure to the games rulebook. This would include simple turn structure, clear card text with short instructions and visual icons that explain card effects. PLayers can then learn the game quickly without needing to memorize complex systems. Being that the game is cooperative and not competitive, players can support teammates who need assistance. Strategies include shared decision making, discussing strategies together; being that there's no player elimination (for the most part) this allows experienced players to assist beginners or younger players. These inclusivity strategies do not weaken gameplay, in fact, I believe it enhances it because this game focues on teamwork over anything else, so I wouldn't have to simplify core mechanics. When converted to a digital version, I might allow difficulty settings.

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Section #4: (2 pts.) Pitch Preparation

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Progress: 100%

Task #1 (2 pts.) - Pitch

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Summarize concept and theme
- Compellingly highlight target audience and unique selling points
- Emphasize how the game stands out in the current market

Your Response:

Pitch - Into the shadows is a cooperative horror exploration board game where players investigate a mysterious mansion that reveals itself one room at a time. As players venture deep into the haunted house, they uncover hidden rooms, dangerous traps, supernatural encounters and clues that reveal the truth behind the mansion's dark past. Theme - The game blends haunted mansion horror, mysterious exploration and cooperative survival. The pixel inspired art style will also create a unique mix of cute and eerie. What makes this so unique are a number of things, such as, the layout of the mansion changes every game using rotating room tiles, the style of the board will use a retro pixel art style inspired by classic RPG visual (think gameboy pokemon) and instead of starting out with a full board, players build the mansion while exploring it! Being that this game is cooperative, families and friends can take a break from competitive game nights to a less stressful yet interesting atmosphere. Many horror board games focus on combat or survival, but into the shadows emphasizes discover, storytelling and exploration.

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Section #5: (2 pts.) Visualizing The Game Concept

Progress: 100%

Task #1 (2 pts.) - Sketches/Storyboard

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Provide at least two sketches
- Sketches should accurately represent the game's concept and theme
- Sketches/storyboards should be coherent with game's style and theme

Library	Library	Dining
Bedroom	Hallway	Basement

Board layout - simple version

EVENT CARD	EVENT CARD	EVENT CARD	EVENT CARD
ITEM CARD	ITEM CARD	ITEM CARD	ITEM CARD

Event card, item card - simple version

TRAP CARD	TRAP CARD	TRAP CARD	TRAP CARD

Suggested colors: Event = Yellow, Item = Green, Trap = Red.

trap card - simple version

```
+-----------+-----------+-----------+
| Study     | Hallway   | Kitchen   |
| (E)       |           | (T)       |
+-----------+-----------+-----------+
| Library   | Start     | Dining    |
| (I)       | Room      | (E)       |
+-----------+-----------+-----------+
| Bedroom   | Hallway   | Basement  |
| (I)       |           | (T)       |
+-----------+-----------+-----------+
```

Legend:

E — Event room
T — Trap room
I — Item room

Room layout example

Game Overview

Players work together as investigators exploring a haunted mansion filled with supernatural dangers. As players move through the house they reveal new room tiles, draw event cards, collect items, and attempt to solve the mystery before the mansion overwhelms them.

Players

2–4 players

Game Length

30–60 minutes

Sneakpeek into the rulebook

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Section #6: (2 pts.) External Feedback

Progress: 100%

Task #1 (0.67 pts.) - Feedback 1

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Note the person's name and relation to you
- Summarize feedback focusing on concept, mechanics, and style
- Reflect on how the feedback will be used to refine the design

Your Response:

Eliana Cordero - Older sister

This reminds me of Clue because of the board layout, but overall this is really unique. I really like the idea of working together rather than against each other because we can take our time and really get to know the game. In terms of the monsters, how would this work? Would we keep track of a fear meter or do people have a certain amount of lives? How do people lose in this game?

My reflection: The monster part has to be the biggest challenge for me at this point in time. I'm hoping by th following week, I'll have some ideas.

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Task #2 (0.67 pts.) - Feedback 2

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Note the person's name and relation to you
- Summarize feedback focusing on concept, mechanics, and style
- Reflect on how the feedback will be used to refine the design

Your Response:

Sofie - Colleague who loves games

This has a unique set up and the structure of the game is very interesting and appealing. I would think about whether you want this game to be played multiple times with the same story line or will there be multiple mysteries that need to be solved?

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My reflection: I would like to make three alternate endings if I have the creative juices flowing. One ending would be everyone escapes unharmed but the house remains haunted. Second mystery would be to find out what happened to the family in this house and set them free and then the alternative could be that someone amongst the group is actually the killer...and if the group members can't identify the killer then they all die!

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Task #3 (0.67 pts.) - Feedback 3

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Note the person's name and relation to you
- Summarize feedback focusing on concept, mechanics, and style
- Reflect on how the feedback will be used to refine the design

Your Response:

Silvester Eduardo - my partner

So far, I think you're on the right path to creating a really fun game. I would suggest keeping the storyline simple; adding three different endings might be confusing. People like simplicity.

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